Hospital 340B Reporting Narrative

Fiscal Year 2025

Community Health Initiatives/Programs

- Pharmacist-led Warfarin Management Clinic:
  - Provides anticoagulation dosing and INR monitoring services for patients receiving ongoing care through the hospital's Primary Care practice. The program utilizes inpatient pharmacy staff to deliver dosing recommendations, laboratory monitoring, and patient follow-up aimed at improving medication safety and adherence.
  - 340b supported savings help offset pharmacist and pharmacy technician labor as well as the cost of specialized anticoagulation management software required to operate the program (annual fee of $2,500). This clinic improves the quality and safety of care for patients on warfarin. Support for this program would be difficult to sustain without 340b participation.
- Medicine-On-Time (MOT) Program:
  - MOT is a program where a patient's medications are placed in sealed pill cups that correspond to what time of day they should take those medications. It is designed to improve medication adherence and more importantly, medication safety. This service is provided to patients free of charge. Patients are enrolled based on need and provider requests. The demand for this service is greater than what we can provide due to space and staffing demands.
  - Costs for this program include specialized software, supplies, and both Pharmacist and Pharm Tech time. Total cost per year is approximately $42K. Our 340B program savings allows us to offer this program to patients.
- Community Wellness Programs:
  - GCFHH offers very popular wellness programs which are free to participants. Currently, we offer eight strong bones classes weekly, and one Tai Chi class weekly. All classes are one hour in length and all but two are taught by GCH staff.
  - Staff cost is $11K annually.
- VeggieVanGo:
  - GCFHH is host for the Vermont Foodbank VeggieVanGo (VVG) monthly drop-off event in our area. VVG fresh produce events are a great way for

community members to expand their menu and stretch their food budget! There are no eligibility requirements or reservations needed to access this program.
    - GCFHH staff organize the monthly event and several staff members assist in distributing the food.
- Resource Advocate:
    - GCFHH employs a full-time Resource Advocate to assist patients and community members who may qualify for state, county, and federal programs. Appointments with her are free and confidential.
    - The Patient Resource Advocate can assist with:
        - Determining eligibility and helping qualifying patients apply for Financial Assistance for services rendered at GCFHH.
        - Obtaining or maintaining health insurance through Vermont Health Connect (VHC)
        - Choosing a Medicare D Plan
        - Applying for free or reduced-cost prescription medications
        - Estimating upcoming medical expenses at GCFHH
        - Finding resources for financial assistance with food, fuel, and housing expenses
    - The Resource Advocate, as part of her job, also assists at both VeggieVanGo and the Townshend Food Shelf.
- Free Care / Bad Debt:
    - The 340B program revenues help cover the cost of Free Care and Bad Debt (much of GCFHH's Bad Debt would be Free Care if only patients would complete Financial Assistance applications). In FY2025 total Free Care was $441K and total Bad Debt was $1.3M.
- Vermont Medicaid Shortfall:
    - The most significant benefit of the 340B program is covering a small part of the annual cost of the Vermont Medicaid Program to GCFHH. Per our FY2024 IRS Form 990 (FY2025 hasn't been completed yet), that shortfall amounted to $3.4M, a combination of reimbursements being considerably less than the actual cost of providing care to Medicaid patients and the Provider Tax assessment imposed on Vermont hospitals. The 340B program is vital to keeping GCFHH alive – assuring both access and quality care for all of our community that rely on our facility.

<u>GCFHH's Internal Review and Oversight</u>

- Self-audits are completed quarterly to ensure program integrity and oversight. Any concerns are investigated and addressed according to policy and procedure. Results of the self-audits are reviewed and discussed during 340B Oversight Team meetings. Independent external audits are performed annually.

Administering The 340B Program

- GCFHH does not attempt to calculate an arbitrary amount for internal expenses related to administering the 340B program. There are far too many individuals throughout the facility whose day-to-day job descriptions include dealing with the extra work of administering the 340B program in varied ways, including all Hospital Pharmacy staff, all Retail Pharmacy staff, and some Finance staff.